

Towards Poster Presentations

Can Kultur

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Understanding the Purpose

Core Idea

- A visual **conversation starter**, not a paper on a wall
- Think "**billboard**" — not "journal article"
- The poster is your visual aid for your presentation

Goal

- **Attract viewers** quickly
- Communicate your **core message** in 30 seconds
- **Spark dialogue** with your audience

Your audience

- People never heard of your project
- Range from technical supervisors to non-specialist visitors

So, **design for the first-time viewer.**

Note that you will be there to fill in the gaps.

Way of Thinking Before You Start

Start with

- "My poster is about _____ and it matters because _____"
- Identify ONE core message — everything else supports it
- Design for a 30-second glance AND a 3-minute deep read

Know your audience

- Who will be walking by? Experts, Generalists, or both?
- What do you want them to walk away knowing?

Design Your Anchor Visual First

- One strong focus point, diagram or image that tells your whole story
- Build everything else around it

Quantify Before You Design

- If you can't state your result as a number, it isn't ready. (e.g. 94% reduction in __)
- Numbers stop viewers — descriptions don't
- Charts, graphs, diagrams help a lot.

Structure & Content Planning

First Half

- **Title:** short, bold; communicate the so-what instantly
- **Problem Statement:** frame it as a question/phrase the audience cares about
- **Background / Introduction:**
Make it clear and simple (e.g. 3–4 bullets)
- **Research Question / Objective:**
Make it explicit and visually prominent
- **Methods:**
Prefer use of a diagram or flowchart, not prose. Simple list of steps may also work.

Second Half

- **Results:** the heart of the poster; visuals over tables
- **Impact / Business Value:**
quantified before/after comparisons
- **Conclusion / Takeaways:**
3–5 punchy bullets that synthesize, do not repeat directly
- **Limitations / Future Directions:**
Sometimes optional but shows depth
- **Contact / QR Code**
always good to have; label what it links to

Visual Design Best Practices

Layout & Hierarchy

- Visual hierarchy:
title → main finding → supporting detail
- Reading flow: left to right, top to bottom (Z or F pattern)



White Space

- White space is not wasted space
- If a section feels full, remove something
- Every section needs breathing room

Color, Type, Figures, Diagrams

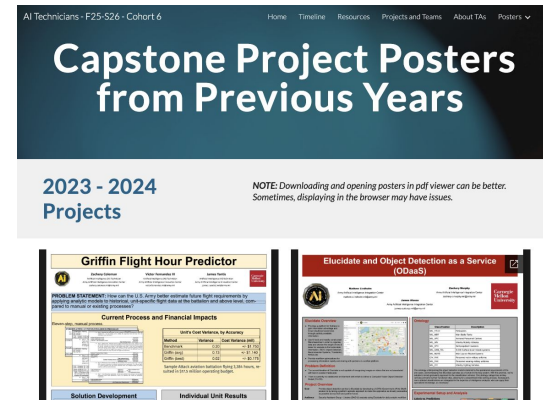
- 2–3 fonts maximum
- 2–3 colors with high contrast
- Apply color coding consistently
- Side-by-side comparisons beat sequential desc.
- Avoid clip art; use clean icons or original visuals
- Every figure needs a clear, standalone caption
- Small complex diagrams are better than no diagram

Samples

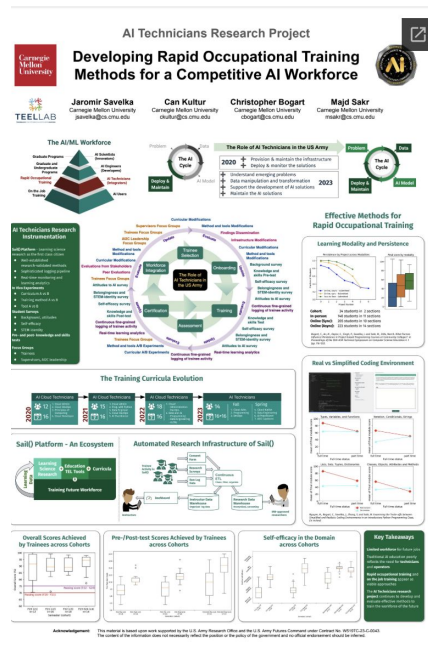
Capstone Project Posters from Previous Years

1. [Griffin AI2C research symposium poster.pdf](#)
2. [Elucidate AI2C research symposium poster.pdf](#)
3. [Spy Turtle AI2C research symposium poster.pdf](#)
4. [Mimir-V AI2C research symposium poster.pdf](#)
5. [Tactical Ope Toolkit - cohort 5 - AI2C Res Symp - capstone poster.pdf](#)
6. [RAADE - cohort 5 - AI2C Res Symp - capstone poster.pdf](#)
7. [Loadout - cohort 5 - AI2C Res Symp - capstone poster.pdf](#)
8. [Spy Turtle Double Vision - cohort 5 - AI2C Res Symp - capstone poster.pdf](#)

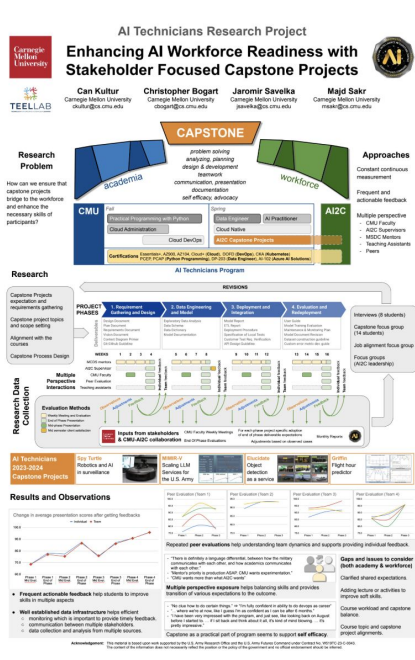
Samples from TEEL lab



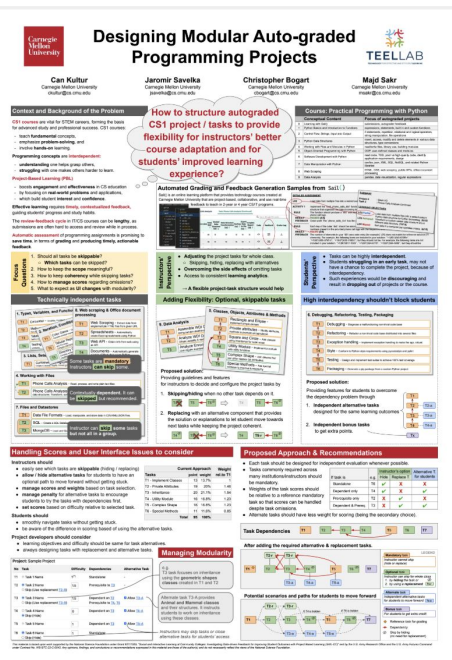
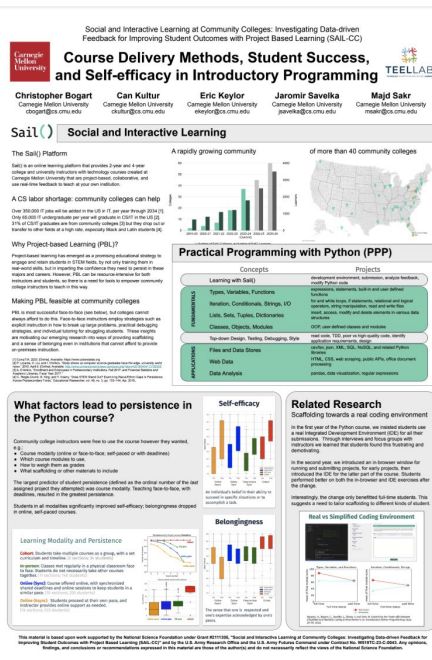
Samples



Less Textual



Conference Posters from TEEL lab

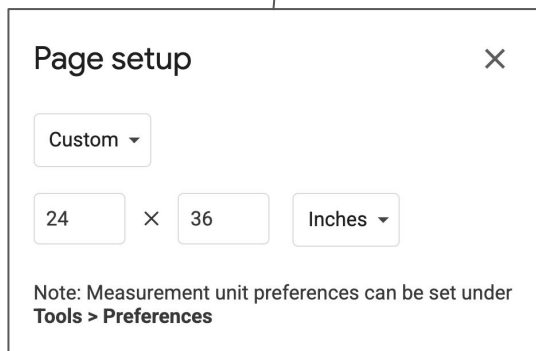


Extremely textual
(even samples are in text)

Poster Template

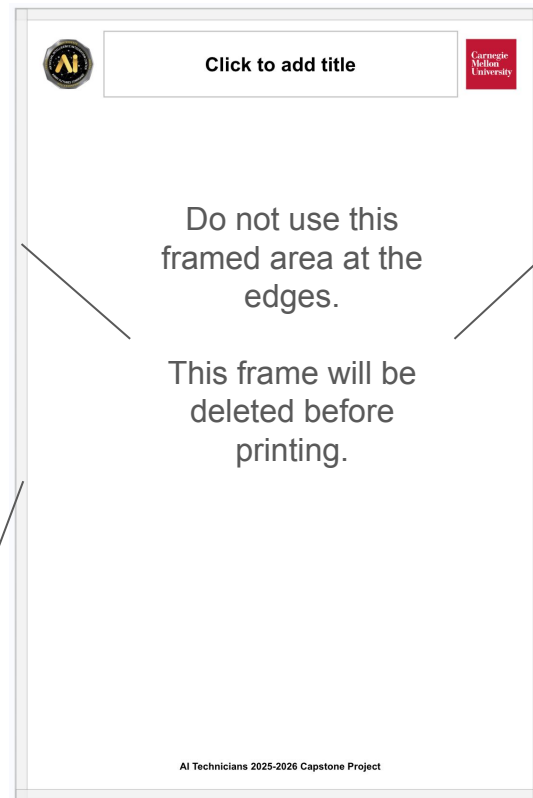
[Poster sample template - 24x36](#)

Note that you see a scaled version in the screen. If you do not use the template make sure the page sizes is correct.



To print in CMU Printing services

1. Poster sizes are available in **either 36 inch or 42 inch wide format.**
2. When designing in PowerPoint or similar application, **never "Copy and Paste" image graphics into your file. Always "Insert as Picture".**
3. When creating a PDF file, please make sure that the **page format dimensions are preserved** before submitting the poster.
4. The printer does not print to the edge of the paper. Please remember to **leave margins of at least 0.5 inches on each side of the print job.**



Thanks